WEBSITE DEVELOPMENT BRIEF

Anthony Aughenbaugh | Initial Launch / Version 1.0

Prepared October 19, 2026 • Working specification for developer discussion

PROJECT INTENT

Create a professional, modern engineering website under Anthony Aughenbaugh's name. It should primarily attract manufacturing and engineering consulting inquiries and showcase real work, while functioning as a credible professional portfolio for future career opportunities. It must not read as an active job search.

Owner / public identity	Anthony Aughenbaugh
Current title	Sales and Manufacturing Engineer
Experience	Manufacturing and engineering experience since 2018
Location / service area	Near DeKalb, Illinois; Northern Illinois and southern Wisconsin near the Illinois border; remote consulting as appropriate
Brand / domain	Personal name brand. Proposed domain: anthonyaughenbaugh.com (availability and spelling to be verified before purchase).
Primary audience	Manufacturing customers, engineering collaborators, and potential consulting clients
Secondary audience	Employers, recruiters, and engineering leadership contacts
Opportunity focus	Hands-on engineering management, manufacturing consulting, technical project ownership

1 | Visual Direction

- Modern engineering aesthetic only: charcoal / dark-gray base with blue highlights; premium, restrained and technically grounded.
- Inspiration: Satisfactory game page (https://coffeestain.com/game/satisfactory/). Capture its industrial atmosphere, bold visuals, dramatic contrast, and confident typography—not game-specific graphics, logos, or artwork.
- Homepage hero should feature a professional headshot and concise positioning, with selected engineering imagery as secondary visual interest.
- Use strong typography, generous spacing, dark cards, subtle blue outlines, clean diagrams/icons, and crisp technical project imagery.
- Keep animations subtle and optional; performance, accessibility and readability take priority. Support reduced-motion preferences.

Suggested visual tokens (developer may adjust)

Background	Charcoal #131A22 / section background #1D2732

Surface/card	Slate #263342
Accent	Engineering blue #2D9CDB; hover/focus #62B7EE
Text	Near-white #F3F6F9; secondary gray #BAC6D1
Typography	Modern sans-serif with readable body text; no mandatory paid font

2 | Navigation & Page Requirements

Home	**Professional positioning; headshot; short introduction; featured project cards; services preview; CTA: Explore Projects / Discuss a Project.**
About	Longer biography, education, career background, professional interests, hands-on management philosophy; link to experience.
Projects	Filterable or categorized project overview; individual project detail pages with images, context, role, methods, outcomes.
Services	Describe consulting capabilities honestly: manufacturing process support, CNC strategy, estimating, facility/process analysis, project support; clear inquiry CTA.
Experience	Structured professional timeline, categorized skills, education, downloadable selectable-text PDF résumé; no “actively seeking work” language.
Insights	Technical article landing page and reusable article template; can launch empty with the menu item hidden until first publication.
Contact	Simple contact form with spam protection, professional contact email, service region, LinkedIn link when provided.

Homepage suggested section order

Navigation → hero with headshot/title/CTAs → capabilities (3 cards) → selected projects (3 cards) → working approach → experience highlights / education → contact call-to-action → footer.

3 | Initial Content & Portfolio

Launch target: three to five publish-ready, permission-cleared case studies; create the reusable system and categories now so Anthony can add more later.

Potential projects	**Raspberry Pi stepper motor control project; tool organizer; manufacturing layout/facility planning; release decision analysis (publish when appropriate); selected CNC/manufacturing projects.**
Project categories	CNC & Manufacturing; Manufacturing Engineering;

	Industrial Engineering; Analysis & Decisions; Automation & Prototyping; CAD & Design.
Reusable case-study fields	Title; short summary; project type (academic / professional / personal); challenge; constraints; Anthony's role; process/tools; solution; results/lessons; media; public-sharing status.
Media	Image galleries, captions, optional embedded videos; avoid confidential drawings or client information unless cleared.
Launch publishing rule	Do not display placeholder projects publicly as completed work. Use drafts until reviewed.

4 | Professional Background — Verified for Drafting

- Current role: Sales and Manufacturing Engineer. Manufacturing/engineering experience since 2018.
- Education: Associate in Engineering Science — Illinois Valley Community College (IVCC).
- Bachelor's degree: Manufacturing Engineering Technology (institution and graduation year to confirm).
- Master's degree in progress: Industrial and Systems Engineering, specialization in Engineering Management (institution and expected graduation year to confirm).
- Professional positioning: Practical manufacturing execution combined with engineering analysis, manufacturing economics and hands-on technical leadership.

Final résumé content (employers, exact dates, achievements, certifications, software/tool proficiency) must be supplied or reviewed by Anthony before publishing.

5 | Editing, Accounts & Handoff

- Anthony must own the domain registration, hosting account, repository/codebase (if applicable), administrator access, and site content. Developer receives delegated access.
- Platform is undecided. Developer may recommend a CMS/site architecture, but it must make routine text, image, service, portfolio and article edits practical for Anthony. Anthony is comfortable coding.
- Provide repeatable Project and Article content templates with draft/publish workflow, image resizing, and simple metadata editing.
- Provide a brief owner tutorial covering text edits, new projects, image swaps, publishing and restoring backups.
- Record hosting costs, any paid themes/plugins, maintenance requirements, and upgrade limitations before implementation.
- Use personal/client-safe data handling. Protect form submissions, limit stored inquiry data, and keep dependencies updated.

6 | Search, SEO & AI Discoverability

- Create indexable HTML pages with real text: headings, descriptive project write-ups, and specific skill phrases rather than image-only presentations.
- Use unique titles/meta descriptions, meaningful URL slugs, canonical links, XML sitemap, robots.txt, useful internal links, and descriptive image alt text.

- Add appropriate JSON-LD structured data where applicable (Person on profile, ProfilePage, Article; Organization only for a real established business).
- Connect Google Search Console; verify index coverage and sitemap submission after deployment. Add privacy-conscious analytics if approved.
- Explain services and area clearly: manufacturing / industrial engineering consulting in northern Illinois and nearby southern Wisconsin; remote and on-site work. Avoid artificial location keyword stuffing.
- Maintain consistency with LinkedIn and any other public profiles. Structured data and clear text can help understanding but do not guarantee ranking or AI selection.
- Ensure content is crawlable without login, basic site content is present in server-rendered HTML or reliably rendered by search engines, and pages are fast/mobile-friendly.

7 | Functional / Quality Acceptance Criteria

- Mobile, tablet, desktop layouts work without horizontal scrolling; navigation and contact form remain usable.
- Accessible contrast, keyboard navigation, focus indicators, proper semantic headings, form labels, image descriptions, and reduced-motion support.
- Contact form successfully submits and reaches Anthony's designated inbox; spam protection and clear success/error states.
- HTTPS enabled; site indexing settings correct; no confidential draft pages visible to public search.
- Anthony can independently create a new project using the template and publish an article without a developer.
- A working backup/restore procedure exists; domain, hosting and source credentials are handed over securely.
- Pages have reasonable load times with compressed/optimized images; no unnecessary large animation assets.
- Downloadable résumé PDF opens and retains selectable text; web résumé/experience content remains readable separately.

8 | Scope & Phases

Phase 1 — Initial launch	**Home, About, Projects & detail template, Services, Experience, Contact, owner-editing workflow, headshot, 3–5 approved projects, SEO basics, responsive QA.**
Phase 1 optional	Insights template created but not publicly linked until first article; social profile links only when provided.
Phase 2 — Content / discovery	Technical articles, more projects, search-performance review, refined service copy, expanded media.
Phase 3 — Future enhancements	Project filters if not in V1, interactive CAD, engineering calculators, secure drawing intake, appointment scheduling and richer analytics.

9 | Items Needed from Anthony Before Publishing

- Professional headshot and any additional imagery approved for use.
- Current résumé or employment timeline; employers, title dates, achievements, and relevant technical skill list.
- Bachelor's institution; master's institution and anticipated completion date, if desired.
- Three to five project summaries/photos with approval for public use and accurate descriptions of individual contributions.
- Preferred contact email, LinkedIn URL, final geographic travel limits, service offering boundaries.
- Approval of written biography/services copy, résumé PDF, visual mockup, and domain spelling.

10 | Developer Decisions to Document

- CMS / framework and hosting recommendation, with reasons, monthly costs, and anticipated maintenance.
- Design mockup for home and project page before full build.
- Content editing strategy, templates, and storage/backups.
- Deployment method, ownership/access handoff, expected turnaround for paid future feature requests.
- Basic privacy notice requirements for contact form/analytics and anti-spam choice.

OUT OF SCOPE FOR V1

E-commerce, client portals, file uploads of confidential drawings, AI chatbots, complex interactive calculators, scheduling integrations, manufacturing job quoting automation, and claims of licensed professional-engineer status.

Success definition: a technically credible, attractive, discoverable portfolio that Anthony can keep current without hiring a developer for ordinary edits, and that clearly invites legitimate engineering consulting inquiries.